LIBRARY MAPATHON · CHEAT SHEET · KEEP THIS

Mapping in OpenStreetMap

This month's project
#69108
Search for it at tasks.hotosm.org

The three names

Name	What it is	Where
OpenStreetMap (OSM)	The free map of the world that anyone can edit. Your account lives here.	openstreetmap.org
HOT Tasking Manager	Where the Humanitarian OpenStreetMap Team lists projects, split into squares (tasks).	tasks.hotosm.org
iD editor	The editor that runs in your browser. This is where you map.	Opens from a task's Map button

Before you start

Make a free account at openstreetmap.org (**Sign Up**) and click the link in your confirmation email. Log in at tasks.hotosm.org with it (**Log in**). New to iD? Do the 10-minute walkthrough: on openstreetmap.org, **Edit**, then **Help › Start the walkthrough**.

☐ **Checkpoint:** your OSM username shows at the top right of the Tasking Manager.

Add to the map

Work at your own pace. Each step ends with a checkpoint you can see on your own screen.

1. **Pick a square.** At tasks.hotosm.org, search for this month's project number and open it. Read the instructions: what to map, and which imagery to use. Pick an available square: **Map › iD Editor**.

   ☐ **Checkpoint:** the project number matches #69108, and the task is locked for mapping by you.

2. **Trace in iD** only what the instructions ask for, inside your square. Projects differ: some ask for buildings, some for roads, some for both.

   ☐ **Checkpoint:** click something you traced: the left panel names a feature type the instructions asked for.

3. **Save and submit.** **Save** every 10 to 20 features. Keep the project hashtag in the comment, add **#AUmapathon** and a few words on what you mapped, then **Upload**. Back in the Tasking Manager: answer yes to "completely mapped" and submit, or choose **Stop mapping**. Both are fine.

   ☐ **Checkpoint:** the Save button shows 0 unsaved edits, and your square changes color on the project map.

Task square colors

The project map shows each square's status. Hover over a square, or check the legend on the project page, to see which squares are available, locked by someone, mapped, or validated. Only pick an available square.

Mapping responsibly

From satellite imagery you can see the shapes of buildings and roads, not what a place is called or how people use it. People who live there add those details. Follow the project's instructions, map only what you can clearly see, and leave names and labels to local mappers.

Keyboard shortcuts in iD

On a Mac, use ⌘ for Ctrl and Option for Alt. Press ? in iD for the full list.

Key	Does	Key	Does
1 / 2 / 3	Add a point / line / area	Ctrl + Z	Undo
Enter or Esc	Finish drawing	Ctrl + Shift + Z	Redo
Hold Alt	Draw without snapping to nearby features	Ctrl + S	Save
Q	Square the corners	W	Wireframe view, to see the imagery under features
O	Make it round	B	Background imagery panel
M / R	Move / rotate the selected feature	Ctrl + B	Switch to the previous imagery
Ctrl + Backspace	Delete the selected feature	H	Help

Good habits

- Buildings: trace the footprint where the building meets the ground, not the roof, which leans in the photo.
- Don't overlap buildings, and don't join them to roads.
- Map only inside your square. Whoever maps the next square will finish the edges.
- If the imagery is blurry or cloudy, say so in the comment and stop mapping that task. That's useful information too.
- Not sure? Leave it out. A validator checks every task, so a careful partial job beats a fast, messy one.

Common snags

Problem	Fix
Not sure you're in the right project	Compare the number at the top of the project page with this month's, above. If they differ, search for this month's number again.
Not sure what to map	Reopen the project's Instructions tab, or ask a helper.
No confirmation email	Check spam, then try another address.
iD opened in the wrong place	Go back to the Tasking Manager and click Map on your task again.
iD didn't open at all	Allow pop-ups for tasks.hotosm.org, then click Map again.
The project has no available squares	Ask a helper for a backup project.
Trackpad is hard to trace with	Ask a helper for a spare mouse.

Keep going on your own

- Same account, any time: tasks.hotosm.org. Filter projects for beginners.
- Check your OSM messages in the next week or two. Validators sometimes leave feedback on first edits.
- LearnOSM beginner guide: learnosm.org/en/beginner
- MapSwipe, a phone app for a few spare minutes: missingmaps.org/mapswipe
- More next steps: the On Your Own guide on the mapathon website.

Adapted from the LearnOSM guides (CC0) and the iD editor's shortcut list. Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL). Workshop materials CC BY-NC-SA 4.0. Developed by the Geospatial Research Lab, American University Library.